Gloria Chen

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Education

University of Melbourne 2019 - 2021
Bachelor of Commerce. Major in Economics and Finance
WAM:91.381

University of Melbourne 2022
Bachelor of Commerce (Honours) in Economics
Advisor: Dr Siqi Pan & Dr Alexandra de Gendre
WAM: 92.875 (Awarded the FBE Honours Prize – First place in the Faculty of Business and Economics)

University of Melbourne 2023 - 2024
Master of Commerce (Economics)
Advisor: Dr. Siqi Pan & Prof. Tom Wilkening & Dr. Georgy Artemov
WAM: 91.143

University of Melbourne 2025 - Present
Ph.D in Economics
Advisor: Dr. Siqi Pan & Prof. Tom Wilkening & Dr. Georgy Artemov

Research Interests

- Market Design
- Microeconomics Theory
- Experimental and Behavioural Economics

Working Papers

When Words Move Rankings: Strategic Messaging in Matching Markets
With Dr. Siqi Pan

The proposing side in Deferred Acceptance is deliberately chosen to ensure strategy-proofness for proposers and the proposer-optimal stable matching. In a lab experiment, we show that pre-match communication can undermine this design choice. Receivers strategically target their partners under the receiver-optimal stable matching with messages expressing strong interest, inducing proposers to deviate from truth-telling by ranking the sender higher. This shifts outcomes back in receivers' favor, significantly so when messages carry a commitment to rank the recipient first. Our findings identify strategic messaging as a novel form of receiver manipulation and suggest that the communication environment should be part of market design.

Work in Progress

Sorting Talent, Distorting Skills: How Precision Shapes Meritocratic Selection?
Solo-authored

Selection mechanisms, such as exams, aim to sort more productive applicants into higher-return positions, but they also shape how applicants allocate effort across skills. By assessing only a subset of productive skills, exams improve sorting while distorting skill composition. I study how exam noise affects this trade-off and aggregate match value. Exams can outperform a lottery at low and high noise levels yet underperform at intermediate levels. Starting from a precise exam, adding noise weakens sorting before it becomes sufficiently large to discourage skill distortions. Losses from distorted skill composition can therefore outweigh the remaining sorting gains. Further increases in noise ultimately make allocation less responsive to tested-skill effort, moving skill composition closer to its optimum and allowing sorting gains to dominate again. Improving exam performance may therefore require either greater precision to strengthen sorting or greater noise to bring effort allocation closer to the optimal skill composition.

Information Provision in School Choice: A Theoretical Perspective
With Dr. Georgy Artemov

Students from low-socioeconomic (low-SES) backgrounds often face substantial information frictions in school choice. This paper examines the welfare implications of two types of information interventions—providing students with common information (CI) and group-specific information (GI)—in a many-to-one matching model

with a continuum of students and a finite set of schools. We show that while CI and GI perform similarly when adopted on a small scale, GI strictly outperforms CI when the information uptake is high. At scale, CI generates congestion externalities that reduce the benefit to informed low-SES students and hurt both high-SES and uninformed low-SES students. GI eliminates this congestion. These findings also hold when the school district implements affirmative action policies. The policy implication is that districts should prioritise information interventions that promote heterogeneity in student preferences.

Closing the Gap: The Role of University Financial Aid Information on Students' Education Decisions
With Dr. Alexandra de Gendre and Dr. Siqi Pan

- Designed a "Financial Aid Calculator" to provide tailored information to high school students in Victoria. - Demonstrated the lack of college aid information among rural Australian youth.
- Showed that the information treatment effectively adjusted students' beliefs about aid accessibility, university affordability, and their tendency to pursue higher education.
- This thesis was awarded first place in the Deakin Essay Competition (2022) and received the highest score in the Economics Honours cohort.

Research Assistant

Market Design for Land Trade: Evidence from Uganda and Kenya 2023-Present
For Prof. Tom Wilkening, A/Prof. Jonathan de Quidt, A/Prof. Gharad Bryan

- Processed and cleaned data across the full study, from baseline through trade elicitation to endline, using R.
- Coded the matching algorithms linking farmers to available land and identifying potential trade opportunities.
- Contributed to survey instrument design for field experiments.
- Constructed replication packages.

Achievements

Scholarships & Fellowships

- FBE Graduate Research Travelling Scholarship (FBE-GRATS) – 2026
  Competitive, merit-based travel funding of AUD 3,530.
- Helen Macpherson Smith Scholarship (Humanities and Social Science) – 2025
  Awarded to the top-ranked female candidate in Humanities and Social Sciences, based on highest overall score, academic excellence, and research potential.
- Australian Government Research Training Program Scholarship (Stipend) – 2025
- Research Training Program Scholarship (Fee offset) – 2025
- Business and Economics Doctoral Program Scholarship – 2023
- Life Course Centre Pathways Scholarship – 2022
- Commerce Achievement Scholarship – 2019

Prizes

- Runner-up, Faculty of Business and Economics Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition – 2026
- Jean Polglaze Memorial Prize, Honours Research Essay – 2022
  Awarded for best Economics Honours thesis.
- William Noall & Son Prize, Faculty of Business and Economics – 2022
  Awarded to top-achieving final-year Bachelor of Commerce Honours student.
- Economics Honours Prize, Department of Economics – 2022
  Awarded to top-performing student in Economics Honours program.
- First Place, Deakin Essay Competition (Honours and Master Thesis) – 2022
- Deputy Dean's Award – 2020
- First Place, Microeconometrics and Experimental Economics (Honours coursework) – 2022
- Department of Economics Prize, Advanced Microeconomics – 2022
- Eric J. Ingram Prize, Macroeconomics – 2023
- Jean Polglaze Memorial Prize, Time Series Analysis and Forecasting – 2021
- Dean's Honour List – 2019, 2020, 2021

Conferences and Workshops

- Annual Australia New Zealand Workshop on Experimental Economics, Dunedin, New Zealand 2026
- Asia-Pacific Meeting of the Economic Science Association, Melbourne, Australia 2026
- Australasian Economic Theory Workshop, Auckland, New Zealand 2026
- MatchLab Workshop, Melbourne, Australia 2025

Teaching

- Advanced Microeconomics (ECON40001): Honours core microeconomics
- Economics of Finance (ECON90034): Master's level subject
- Microeconomics II (ECON90045): Master's level subject
- Microeconomics (ECON30010): Final-year core subject
- Behavioural Economics (ECON30019): Administrative Tutor (2023)
- Econometrics I (ECOM20001): Core subject for second-year undergraduates
- Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON20002): Second-year core subject
- Introductory Microeconomics (ECON10004): First-year core subject
- Investment (FNCE30001): Final-year finance core subject

Personal Information

Software: R, Python, oTree, Stata, MATLAB, Mathematica, EViews, QGIS
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Citizenship: Australian